

INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PROJECT

Digital Marketing and Consumer
Purchase Intention:

A Case Study of CJ Olive Young and
Social Media Marketing

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Research Focus

Digital Marketing • Social Media Marketing •

Consumer Behavior • Purchase Intention • Brand

Awareness • Consumer Engagement • Omnichannel Marketing

Abstract

Digital marketing has become an important component of modern marketing strategy as businesses increasingly use digital channels to communicate with consumers, provide information, build relationships, and support purchasing decisions. Social media, digital content, influencer marketing, user-generated content, data analytics, and omnichannel services have created multiple digital touchpoints through which consumers can interact with brands.

This research examines the relationship

between digital marketing activities and consumer purchase intention, with particular attention to social media marketing. The study uses a qualitative research approach based on literature review, documentary analysis, and a case study of CJ Olive Young, a South Korean health and beauty retailer. The research does not employ questionnaires, interviews, experiments, or statistical testing of primary consumer data. The Olive Young case was selected because the company provides a relevant example of the integration of digital communication, data-driven marketing, e-commerce, physical retail, and omnichannel customer experiences. Existing documentary evidence shows that Olive Young has used online and offline customer data to analyze purchasing behavior, search activity, conversion patterns, and customer journeys. Academic research has also examined Olive Young's omnichannel services and found

significant relationships between channel connectivity, information consistency, convenience, consumer engagement, and continued usage intention.

The analysis suggests that digital marketing may contribute to purchase intention through several interconnected mechanisms, including brand awareness, consumer engagement, information quality, brand perceptions, trust, convenience, and customer experience.

However, the relationship should not be interpreted as a simple or universally causal effect. The findings instead indicate that digital marketing is most meaningful when different activities operate together as part of an integrated customer journey.

Keywords: Digital Marketing, Social Media Marketing, Consumer Behavior, Purchase Intention, Brand Awareness, Consumer Engagement, Omnichannel Marketing, Olive

1. Introduction

The rapid development of digital technologies has changed the way businesses communicate with consumers and manage marketing activities. Digital platforms allow companies to distribute information, interact with consumers, collect behavioral data, personalize communication, and connect online and offline customer experiences.

Unlike traditional marketing communication, digital marketing can provide consumers with opportunities to interact with brands and other consumers. Social media users can comment on content, share information, create their own

content, review products, and participate in brand-related communities. These characteristics have made digital marketing particularly relevant to consumer behavior. One important outcome examined in consumer behavior research is purchase intention. Purchase intention refers to a consumer's willingness or likelihood to purchase a product or service. It is related to, but should not be treated as identical to, actual purchasing behavior. Digital marketing may influence purchase intention through several mechanisms. Consumers may first become aware of a product through digital content or social media. They may then search for information, read reviews, watch demonstrations, interact with creators or other consumers, and evaluate alternatives before forming an intention to purchase.

This research examines these relationships through a qualitative case study of CJ Olive Young, a major South Korean health and beauty retailer. Olive Young is particularly relevant because its business model combines physical stores with digital commerce and data-driven customer analysis.

1.1 Research Problem

Although digital marketing is widely used by businesses, its relationship with consumer purchase intention is not necessarily direct or uniform. Different digital activities may influence different stages of the consumer decision-making process.

Therefore, rather than treating digital marketing as a single activity, this research examines several interconnected dimensions, including:

- Social media marketing

- Content marketing
- Influencer and creator marketing
- Electronic word-of-mouth
- User-generated content
- Data-driven marketing
- Consumer engagement
- Omnichannel marketing

The study then examines how these activities may contribute to consumer awareness, perceptions, engagement, and purchase intention through the Olive Young case.

1.2 Main Research Question

What is the relationship between digital marketing activities and consumer purchase intention, particularly through social media marketing and related digital mechanisms?

1.3 Sub-questions

1. How may social media marketing influence consumer purchase intention?
 2. What role may brand awareness play in the relationship between digital marketing and purchase intention?
 3. How may digital marketing activities influence consumer perceptions and attitudes toward brands?
 4. What factors may contribute to the effectiveness of social media marketing?
 5. How can businesses use digital marketing to strengthen consumer engagement and support purchase intention?
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2. Research Objectives

2.1 Main Objective

To examine and analyze the relationship between digital marketing activities and consumer purchase intention, with particular attention to social media marketing and the case of CJ Olive Young.

2.2 Specific Objectives

1. To examine how social media marketing may influence consumer purchase intention.
2. To analyze the role of brand awareness in digital marketing.
3. To examine the relationship between digital marketing activities and consumer perceptions.
4. To identify factors that may contribute to effective social media marketing.
5. To examine how businesses can use digital

marketing to strengthen consumer engagement and support purchase intention.

6. To apply relevant marketing concepts to a real-world Korean business case.
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3. Research Methodology

3.1 Research Design

This research uses a qualitative and exploratory approach based on:

- Literature review
- Documentary analysis
- Case-study analysis

CJ Olive Young is selected as the case because its business model provides a relevant example

of the integration of digital marketing, e-commerce, physical retail, data analysis, and omnichannel customer experiences.

3.2 Data Sources

The study relies on secondary sources, including:

- Academic journal articles
- Research papers
- Books
- Official company sources
- Documented technology/business case studies
- Industry sources
- Other reliable documentary materials

3.3 Data Analysis

The research analyzes existing literature and documentary evidence and compares the

evidence with the conceptual framework developed in the study.

The purpose is not to statistically measure the effect of digital marketing on consumers.

Instead, the study identifies patterns and possible mechanisms through which digital marketing activities may contribute to consumer awareness, engagement, perceptions, and purchase intention.

3.4 Research Scope and Limitation of Method

The present research does not use:

- Questionnaires
- Interviews
- Experiments
- Direct observation
- Primary consumer data
- Statistical hypothesis testing

Therefore, the findings should be interpreted as a qualitative analysis rather than empirical proof of a causal relationship.

4. Theoretical Framework

The theoretical framework examines how digital marketing activities may be connected to consumer responses.

The proposed relationship is:

Digital Marketing Activities



Brand Exposure & Information



Brand Awareness / Consumer Engagement



Brand Perceptions / Trust



Purchase Consideration & Intention

This framework does not suggest that purchase intention is determined by digital marketing alone. Consumer characteristics, product quality, price, availability, previous experience, social influence, and other environmental factors may also influence purchasing decisions.

4.1 Digital Marketing

Digital marketing refers broadly to marketing activities conducted through digital technologies and channels. These activities may include social media marketing, online advertising, content marketing, search marketing, email marketing, influencer marketing, and digital brand communication.

Digital marketing provides businesses with multiple opportunities to communicate with

consumers and collect information about consumer behavior.

4.2 Social Media Marketing

Social media marketing involves the use of social networking platforms and online communities to communicate with consumers, distribute content, encourage interaction, and develop relationships.

Social media differs from traditional one-way communication because consumers can respond to brands, share content, provide opinions, and communicate with other consumers.

4.3 Brand Awareness

Brand awareness refers to consumers' ability to recognize or recall a brand.

Digital marketing can expose consumers to

brands through repeated communication and multiple digital touchpoints. Greater exposure may increase the likelihood that a brand will be recognized or considered during the decision-making process.

4.4 Consumer Engagement

Consumer engagement involves cognitive, emotional, and behavioral involvement with a brand.

In digital environments, engagement can include:

- Viewing content
- Liking
- Commenting
- Sharing
- Discussing
- Creating content
- Participating in campaigns

This makes engagement an important concept for understanding social media marketing.

4.5 Brand Image and Consumer Trust

Brand image represents the associations and perceptions consumers have about a brand. Consumer trust refers to the extent to which consumers perceive a brand as reliable, credible, and capable of delivering expected value. Digital reviews, recommendations, electronic word-of-mouth, creator content, and brand interactions may influence these perceptions.

4.6 Purchase Intention

Purchase intention refers to a consumer's willingness or likelihood to purchase a product or service.

It represents an important stage in the consumer decision-making process, but it

should not be treated as equivalent to actual purchasing behavior.

Digital marketing may contribute to purchase intention by providing information, increasing awareness, encouraging engagement, reducing uncertainty, and supporting product evaluation.

5. Major Digital Marketing Strategies

5.1 Social Media Marketing

Social media allows companies to communicate with consumers and encourage interaction.

For businesses, social media may function both as a promotional channel and as a relationship-building environment.

5.2 Content Marketing

Content marketing involves creating and distributing relevant, useful, informative, or entertaining material.

Examples include:

- Product information
- Tutorials
- Demonstrations
- Short-form videos
- Reviews
- Educational content
- Brand stories
- User-generated content

Relevant content may assist consumers during information search and product evaluation.

5.3 Influencer and Creator Marketing

Influencer marketing involves collaborating with creators who have established audiences or influence within particular online communities. The potential effectiveness of this strategy can depend on credibility, relevance, transparency, authenticity, audience characteristics, and content quality.

5.4 Electronic Word-of-Mouth

Electronic word-of-mouth (eWOM) refers to consumer opinions, recommendations, reviews, and evaluations communicated through digital channels.

Reviews and consumer discussions can provide additional information that may influence product evaluation.

5.5 User-Generated Content

User-generated content refers to content created

by consumers rather than directly by the brand.

It may include:

- Reviews
- Product experiences
- Photos
- Videos
- Recommendations
- Social media posts

Such content can increase consumer participation and provide peer-generated information.

5.6 Data-Driven Marketing

Data-driven marketing involves using consumer and business data to support marketing decisions.

Relevant data may include:

- Search behavior

- Product interests
- Purchasing patterns
- Conversion rates
- Customer journeys
- Online/offline interactions

5.7 Omnichannel Marketing

Omnichannel marketing integrates different customer touchpoints, such as websites, mobile applications, physical stores, and other digital and offline channels.

The objective is to create a more connected and convenient customer journey.

This concept is particularly relevant to Olive Young because the company combines physical retail with digital commerce and customer-data analysis.

6. Case Study: CJ Olive Young

6.1 Company Overview

CJ Olive Young is a South Korean health and beauty retailer that has developed from a traditional retail business into a broader beauty and lifestyle platform.

The company provides a relevant case for this research because its operations combine physical retail, digital commerce, customer data, and online-to-offline experiences.

6.2 Data-Driven Marketing at Olive Young

Documented evidence from Google shows that Olive Young has used Google Analytics to analyze customer behavior across its digital and

physical environments.

The company analyzed customer journeys, search behavior, purchasing behavior, conversion patterns, and points where users left the ordering process. It also examined relationships between product-category searches and purchase conversion rates. This provides concrete evidence that data analysis is incorporated into Olive Young's business and marketing decision-making.

6.3 Online and Offline Integration

Olive Young's business model connects digital and physical retail experiences.

Its use of integrated online and offline customer data has enabled the company to analyze customer behavior across different purchasing environments.

This supports the argument that digital

marketing should not necessarily be analyzed separately from the broader customer experience.

6.4 Omnichannel Marketing and Consumer Engagement

A 2026 study focusing specifically on Olive Young examined the relationships between three structural characteristics of its beauty omnichannel services—channel connectivity, information consistency, and optimized convenience—and consumer engagement and continued usage intention.

The study surveyed 334 consumers who had previously used Olive Young's omnichannel services and reported statistically significant positive relationships between these structural characteristics and both consumer engagement and continued usage intention. Optimized

convenience showed the strongest influence among the examined factors.

This study provides empirical evidence relevant to the theoretical framework of the present research. Importantly, however, those survey results belong to the cited study and are not primary data collected by the present research.

6.5 Social Media and Participatory Marketing

Social media can provide Olive Young and brands operating through its ecosystem with opportunities to communicate products, promote beauty trends, encourage consumer participation, and connect digital communication with purchasing.

A TikTok case involving a Vaseline campaign connected TikTok activity with Olive Young and reported improvements in ad recall and

purchase intent, as well as strong commercial conversion results. This provides an example of how digital campaigns can connect awareness, engagement, and purchasing outcomes in the Olive Young ecosystem.

However, this example concerns a specific campaign rather than Olive Young's entire digital marketing strategy. It therefore should not be generalized to every Olive Young marketing activity.

6.6 Digital Marketing and Consumer Engagement

The Olive Young case illustrates several mechanisms that may support consumer engagement:

- Social media communication
- Product recommendations
- Creator content

- User-generated content
- Digital campaigns
- Data-informed personalization
- Online-to-offline integration
- Omnichannel customer experiences

These mechanisms provide opportunities for consumers to interact with brands and participate in digital experiences.

7. Analysis and Discussion

[7.1](#) Digital Marketing and Brand Awareness

Digital marketing can increase opportunities for brand and product exposure by allowing companies to communicate across multiple

digital channels.

Social media content, digital advertising, creator content, and online product information can introduce consumers to products beyond the physical retail environment.

However, exposure does not automatically result in purchase. Awareness should therefore be viewed as one stage in the consumer decision-making process.

7.2 Social Media Marketing and Consumer Engagement

Social media creates opportunities for consumers to move from passive exposure toward active participation.

Comments, shares, discussions, and user-generated content can increase interaction between consumers and brands.

The importance of engagement is also

consistent with the Olive Young omnichannel study, which found significant relationships between structural characteristics of the service and consumer engagement.

7.3 Influencer Marketing and Consumer Perception

Creator and influencer content can provide consumers with product demonstrations, opinions, recommendations, and experiences. However, influencer marketing should not automatically be assumed to produce positive outcomes. Its effectiveness may depend on credibility, relevance, transparency, authenticity, and content quality.

7.4 Content Marketing and Decision-Making

Digital content can support consumers during

several stages of the decision-making process:

Need Recognition



Information Search



Evaluation of Alternatives



Purchase Intention



Purchase

Product descriptions, reviews, demonstrations, and recommendations can help consumers obtain information and evaluate alternatives.

[7.5](#) Data-Driven Marketing and Consumer Behavior

Olive Young provides a particularly useful example of data-driven marketing.

Google's case study documents the company's

analysis of customer journeys, search behavior, conversion patterns, and online/offline customer behavior.

This suggests that digital data can be used not only for measurement but also for identifying customer needs and improving marketing and customer-experience decisions.

7.6 Omnichannel Marketing and Customer Experience

The Olive Young case demonstrates that digital marketing can operate together with physical retail.

A customer may discover a product digitally, search for information online, visit a physical store, and complete a purchase through an online or offline channel.

The 2026 Olive Young study provides additional evidence that channel connectivity, information

consistency, and convenience are relevant to consumer engagement and continued usage intention.

7.7 Digital Marketing and Purchase Intention

The relationship between digital marketing and purchase intention should not be interpreted as a simple direct causal relationship.

A more appropriate conceptualization is:

Digital Marketing



Exposure / Information



Brand Awareness



Engagement / Evaluation



Brand Perception / Trust



Purchase Consideration



Purchase Intention

The available Olive Young evidence provides examples consistent with parts of this framework, but it does not establish that every digital marketing activity necessarily produces the same outcome.



8. Case Study Analysis

Digital Marketing Element	Olive Young Case	Potential Consumer Outcome
Social Media	Digital	Awareness

Marketing	communicati on and campaigns	and interaction
Content Marketing	Product information and beauty content	Information and evaluation
Creator Marketing	Creator/ influencer communicati on	Product awareness and consideration
User- Generated Content	Consumer participation in campaigns	Engagement
Data-Driven Marketing	Search, purchasing, and conversion	Better customer understandin g

	analysis	
Omnichannel Marketing	Integration of digital and physical channels	Convenience and continuity
Consumer Engagement	Interaction and participation	Greater brand involvement
Digital Conversion	Digital campaigns connected to purchasing	Potential purchase consideration

The table summarizes the mechanisms identified in the literature and documentary evidence. It should not be interpreted as quantitative measurement of Olive Young's performance.

9. Research Findings

Based on the literature review and case-study analysis, several findings can be identified.

9.1 Digital Marketing Can Increase Brand Exposure

Digital channels allow businesses to communicate with consumers across multiple touchpoints and provide information beyond the physical retail environment.

9.2 Social Media Can Support Consumer Engagement

Social media provides opportunities for consumers to interact with brands and

participate in content creation.

9.3 Content Can Support Consumer Decision-Making

Relevant product information, reviews, demonstrations, and recommendations can assist consumers during information search and evaluation.

9.4 Data Can Improve Understanding of Consumer Behavior

The Olive Young case demonstrates the practical use of customer data for analyzing searches, customer journeys, purchasing behavior, and conversion patterns.

9.5 Omnichannel Integration Can Support Customer Experience

Evidence from Olive Young indicates that channel connectivity, information consistency,

and convenience are relevant to consumer engagement and continued usage intention.

9.6 Digital Marketing May Contribute to Purchase Intention Through Multiple Mechanisms

The findings suggest that digital marketing may support purchase intention through a combination of:

- Brand awareness
- Information quality
- Consumer engagement
- Brand perceptions
- Trust
- Convenience
- Customer experience
- Product consideration

Therefore, purchase intention should not be attributed to digital marketing alone.

10. Managerial Recommendations

10.1 Develop Relevant Content

Businesses should create useful, credible, and relevant content that responds to consumer information needs.

10.2 Strengthen Social Media Engagement

Companies should encourage interaction through comments, discussions, interactive campaigns, and consumer participation.

10.3 Use Creator Marketing Strategically

Creators should be selected based on relevance, credibility, audience characteristics, authenticity, and content quality rather than follower numbers alone.

10.4 Encourage User-Generated Content

Consumer reviews, experiences, and creative content can provide additional information and increase participation.

10.5 Use Consumer Data Responsibly

Businesses should use analytics to understand consumer behavior while maintaining appropriate privacy and transparency practices.

10.6 Integrate Online and Offline Channels

Businesses operating across physical and digital channels should provide consistent information and convenient transitions between touchpoints.

10.7 Focus on the Complete Customer Journey

Digital marketing should support consumers from awareness and information search through evaluation, purchase, and post-purchase engagement.

10.8 Build Long-Term Relationships

Businesses should not focus exclusively on short-term conversions. Trust, engagement, customer experience, and meaningful communication can support longer-term consumer relationships.

11. Conclusion

This research examined the relationship between digital marketing and consumer purchase intention, with particular attention to social media marketing and the case of CJ Olive Young.

The analysis suggests that digital marketing can support consumer decision-making through several interconnected mechanisms. Social media and digital content can increase exposure and awareness, while reviews, recommendations, and other forms of digital information can support information search and product evaluation.

The Olive Young case also illustrates the importance of consumer engagement and data-driven marketing. Documented evidence shows that Olive Young has used customer and

behavioral data to analyze search activity, purchasing patterns, customer journeys, and conversion behavior.

The company's omnichannel model provides another important dimension. Research specifically examining Olive Young found that channel connectivity, information consistency, and optimized convenience were positively associated with consumer engagement and continued usage intention.

Overall, the research does not conclude that digital marketing directly or automatically causes consumers to purchase. Instead, it suggests that digital marketing may contribute to purchase intention through a combination of awareness, information, engagement, brand perceptions, trust, convenience, and customer experience.

Therefore, businesses should view digital marketing as an integrated component of the

broader customer journey rather than simply as online advertising.

12. Research Limitations and Future Research

This research has several limitations.

First, it relies primarily on secondary academic and documentary sources rather than primary data collected directly from consumers.

Second, the study focuses on a single company, CJ Olive Young. Therefore, the findings should not automatically be generalized to all companies, industries, or markets.

Third, digital marketing practices and platforms develop rapidly. Some specific practices may therefore change over time.

Fourth, the research focuses on purchase intention rather than directly measuring actual purchasing behavior.

Finally, because the study uses a qualitative case-study approach, future research could strengthen the analysis by:

- Comparing multiple beauty retailers
- Comparing Korean and non-Korean companies
- Conducting consumer surveys
- Conducting interviews
- Testing relationships statistically
- Comparing purchase intention with actual purchasing behavior

Future studies using primary data could provide stronger empirical evidence concerning the relationships proposed in this research.

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Academic Integrity Note

This project is an independent undergraduate research project based on secondary sources and documentary analysis.

No primary survey, interview, experiment, or statistical analysis of original respondent data was conducted by the researcher.

The empirical findings reported from external studies belong to those respective studies and are not presented as original data collected for this project.